My Home Walkthrough Checklist

Oct 31, 2026 · @Susan

How to use this

Walk the house together, one section at a time, and let her do the finding and the photographing. Everything here feeds the **My Home** part of the app, where each item gets a photo and a short note.

- **[Photo]** She takes a picture on her phone, close enough to see the handle or switch.
- **[Practice]** She does it herself once, with you watching.
- **[Look only]** She learns where it is but doesn't touch it.

Plan on about an hour, or split it over two days. Water and fire are the most important; start there.

Water

Used by scenarios 3 (sink or tub) and 4 (toilet).

- [ ] **Main water shutoff** for the whole house. Often in the basement, utility room, or near the water heater. **[Photo] [Practice]** She turns it partway to the right, then back, so she knows how it feels. Note which way is off.
- [ ] **Kitchen sink valves**, under the sink. Hot and cold. **[Photo] [Practice]**
- [ ] **Each bathroom sink's valves.** One photo per sink, labeled by room. **[Photo] [Practice]**
- [ ] **Each toilet's valve**, on the wall behind it. **[Photo] [Practice]**
- [ ] **Inside a toilet tank:** lift the lid together so she sees the float and the flapper. **[Practice]** She lifts the float once.
- [ ] **Tubs and showers:** confirm they have no separate valve, so the main shutoff is the one to use. **[Look only]**
- [ ] **Washing machine valves**, if there's a hose behind it. **[Photo]**
- [ ] **Water heater** location. **[Look only]**

Tip: old valves can be stiff or drip after turning. If one won't move easily, don't force it; note it and have it fixed.

Electricity

Used by scenario 5 (power out).

- [ ] **Breaker panel** location. **[Photo]** One of the panel door, one of the switches inside.
- [ ] **Breaker labels:** check that each switch says which room it controls. Relabel any that are blank or wrong; it makes resetting much easier. **[Photo]** of the label list.
- [ ] **What a tripped breaker looks like:** with you there, switch off one harmless breaker (a bedroom's outlets) so she sees the position, then have her reset it. **[Practice]**
- [ ] **Main breaker,** the large switch at the top. **[Look only]** Only you or Dad use it.
- [ ] **Flashlights:** where they are, and check the batteries. **[Photo]**
- [ ] **Things that tend to trip breakers:** hair dryer, space heater, microwave. Talk through which outlets they share. **[Look only]**

Fire, smoke, and air

Used by scenarios 1 (smoke alarm), 2 (stove), and 11 (carbon monoxide).

- [ ] **Every smoke alarm** in the house. **[Photo]** Note which room each is in.
- [ ] **Every carbon monoxide alarm,** or combined smoke/CO alarm. **[Photo]**
- [ ] **Hear each sound:** press the test button on one smoke alarm and one CO alarm so she knows both sounds. If you can, play the low-battery chirp from the maker's website too. **[Practice]**
- [ ] **Pan lids** in the kitchen, and a baking sheet. Agree on one lid that stays within reach of the stove. **[Photo]**
- [ ] **Stove fan switch. [Practice]** She turns it on and off.
- [ ] **Oven mitts. [Photo]**
- [ ] **Fire extinguisher** location. **[Look only]** The app tells her to use a lid or get out, not the extinguisher.
- [ ] **How to turn off each burner and the oven,** if the knobs are confusing. **[Practice]**

Gas

Used by scenario 12 (smell gas). This section is look-only on purpose: if she smells gas, her job is to leave, not to turn anything.

- [ ] **Gas meter** location outside. **[Look only]**

- [ ] **Which appliances use gas** (stove, furnace, water heater, dryer). **[Look only]** This helps her know where a smell might come from.
- [ ] **What gas smells like:** if a burner on a gas stove is turned on for a second before lighting, she'll recognize the rotten-egg smell. **[Practice]** Only with you there, and only for a moment.

Getting out and getting in

Used by scenarios 1 (smoke alarm), 6 (locked out), 11 (CO), and 12 (gas).

- [ ] **Two ways out of her bedroom,** and two ways out of the house. Walk both. **[Practice]**
- [ ] **Outside meeting spot,** somewhere fixed like the mailbox or a neighbor's tree. **[Photo]**
- [ ] **Other ways in** when locked out: back door, garage keypad code, hidden key, a neighbor who has a key. **[Photo]** of doors only; keep codes out of photos.
- [ ] **Neighbors she can go to** in an emergency. Introduce her if they haven't met. **[Look only]**
- [ ] **Where to wait if it's cold:** a neighbor's house, or a car parked on the street, never in the garage. **[Look only]**

Supplies

Small things she'll reach for in the moment; each gets a photo of where it lives.

- [ ] **Plunger,** one per bathroom if possible. **[Photo]**
- [ ] **Old towels** for spills and floods. **[Photo]**
- [ ] **Rubber gloves. [Photo]**
- [ ] **First aid kit. [Photo]**
- [ ] **Spare batteries** for flashlights. **[Photo]**
- [ ] **Phone charger or power bank** she can grab when leaving. **[Photo]**

Numbers for My People

These go into the app's call list; fill in the blank ones together.

Who	Number
Mom	

Who	Number
Dad	
Aunt	
NOVEC outage line	703-335-0500
Washington Gas emergency leak line	844-927-4427, option 1
Plumber	
Bank card line	On the back of her card